

Before leaving the topic of insurance, it's important to differentiate between health care and health insurance. Many people use the terms interchangeably. They're not the same thing. Health insurance, at least in the US, is primarily concerned with paying for treatment of illnesses or injuries. These impairments are treated with medication, surgery, or other interventions. Health care is a comprehensive approach that focuses on overall wellness and prevention of illness and injury.

Finding health insurance is a significant challenge for those who *Choose FI* and leave the workforce before traditional retirement age (when Medicare is an option). However, the ability to focus on your health care is one of the biggest advantages of choosing FI and living a more intentional lifestyle as soon as possible.

Jonathan

We all too often confuse health insurance with health care. There are three types of health care:

Preventative = Healthy Lifestyle

Maintenance = Dental cleanings, hip replacement, etc.

Acute = The bad stuff that is out of our control (e.g., cancer, heart attack, broken bones, etc.)